

TITLE: Cloud Storage & File Sharing Guidelines

ORGANIZATION: Northwind Analytics, Inc.

DEPARTMENT: IT

SENSITIVITY: Internal

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Cloud Storage & File Sharing Guidelines

These guidelines define approved cloud storage and file-sharing tools and the rules for storing and sharing company data through them.

1. Approved Platforms

NovaDrive (the company's managed Microsoft OneDrive/SharePoint environment) is the only approved platform for storing and sharing Internal, Confidential, or Restricted data as classified under the Data Privacy Policy. Personal cloud storage accounts (personal Google Drive, Dropbox, iCloud, etc.) must never be used for company data.

2. External Sharing Rules

- External sharing links must be set to expire within 30 days by default; permanent external links require Department Head approval.
- Files classified as Confidential or Restricted must never be shared via an anonymous "anyone with the link" setting — recipient-specific sharing (requiring sign-in) is mandatory.
- Manufacturing design files, BOMs (bills of materials), and supplier specifications are classified Confidential by default and require Engineering Lead approval for external sharing, even with existing vendors.

3. Retention and Cleanup

NovaDrive folders inactive for more than 24 months are flagged for archival review. Departing employees' individual drives are retained for 90 days post-exit for manager handover, then archived per the Records Retention Policy.

4. Contact

For sharing permission issues or platform questions: it-helpdesk@northwindanalytics.example.com.